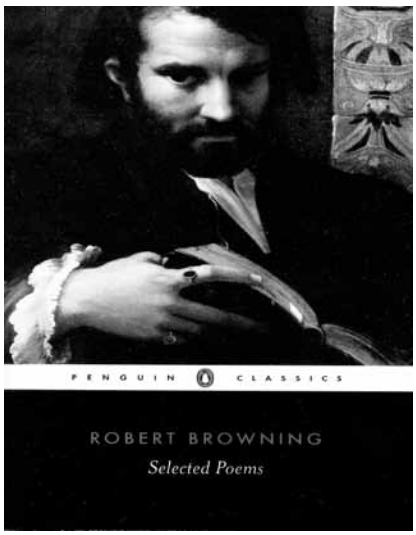
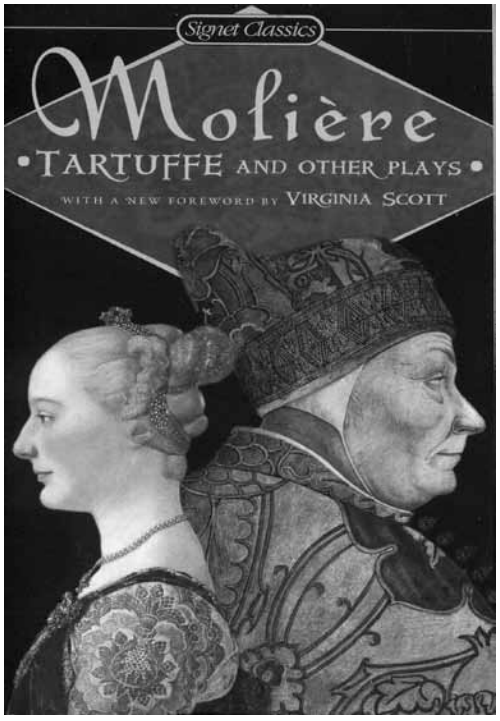
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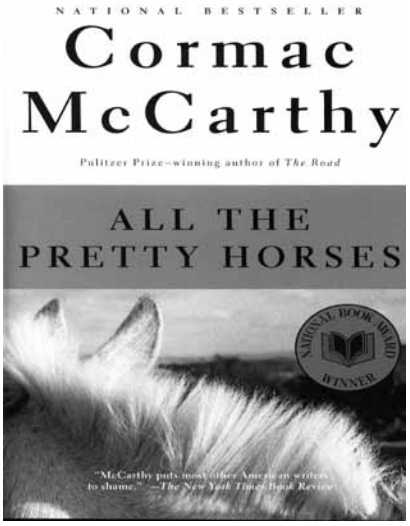
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

Invitational B • 2014







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational B • 2014

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. The form of verse to be sung or recited and characterized by its presentation of a dramatic or exciting episode in simple narrative form is the

   A) antiphon.
   B) ballad.
   C) madrigal.
   D) rondeau.
   E) round.

2. The type of lyric poem that is characterized by its single, unified strain of exalted feeling and style, by its single purpose, and by its dealing with one theme is the

   A) aubade.
   B) elegy.
   C) hymn.
   D) jeremiad.
   E) ode.

3. The nineteenth-century British author of *The Pickwick Papers*, *Bleak House*, *Hard Times*, *Our Mutual Friend*, *Little Dorrit*, and *A Tale of Two Cities* is

   A) Robert Browning.
   B) Thomas Carlyle.
   C) Charles Dickens.
   D) Thomas Hardy.
   E) Rudyard Kipling.

4. The revival of emotional religion during the first half of the eighteenth century in America is (the)

   A) Dandyism.
   B) Great Awakening.
   C) Harlem Renaissance.
   D) Philistinism.
   E) Transcendentalism.

5. All of the poetic feet listed below can comprise duple meter, with the exception of

   A) dactylic.
   B) iambic.
   C) pyrrhic.
   D) spondaic.
   E) trochaic.

6. The nine goddesses represented as presiding over the various departments of art and science are known as the

   A) Furies.
   B) Graces.
   C) Humors.
   D) Muses.
   E) Nine Worthies.

7. The author who is currently involved in a lawsuit with a museum in her hometown and who is the recipient of the 1961 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for her novel *To Kill a Mockingbird* is

   A) Harper Lee.
   B) E. Annie Proulx.
   C) Anne Tyler.
   D) Alice Walker.
   E) Eudora Welty.

8. A novel in which actual persons are presented under the guise of fiction, such as W. Somerset Maugham's *Cakes and Ale*, is known as a(n)

   A) *Bildungsroman*.
   B) *Entwicklungsroman*.
   C) *Künstlerroman*.
   D) *roman à clef*.
   E) *roman à thèse*.

9. **Not** a British writer honored by being awarded a Nobel Prize for Literature is

   A) Albert Camus.
   B) Sir Winston Churchill.
   C) William Golding.
   D) Rudyard Kipling.
   E) Bertrand A. W. Russell.

10. The literary movement immediately associated with the Abbey Theatre and W. B. Yeats is

    A) the Harlem Renaissance.
    B) the Irish Literary Revival.
    C) Johnson's Circle.
    D) the Pre-Raphaelites.
    E) Scholasticism.

11. The repetition of initial consonant sounds or any vowel sounds in successive or closely associated syllables is recognized as

A) alliteration.
B) assonance.
C) consonance.
D) resonance.
E) sigmatism.

12. An eighteenth-century philosophical movement that gave shape to the American Revolution and the two basic documents of the United States, the Declaration of Independence and the Constitution, is the

A) Commonwealth (or Puritan) Interregnum.
B) Enlightenment.
C) Great Awakening.
D) Renaissance.
E) Romantic Movement.

13. **Not** included as one of the stagings comprising the diagram that Gustave Freytag developed as a heuristic means of getting at the structure of a plot line is

A) catastrophe.
B) complication.
C) exposition.
D) reversal.
E) volta.

14. The author who, it was rumored, was considered for the 2010 Nobel Prize for Literature and who did receive the 2007 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for his novel *The Road* is

A) Norman Mailer.
B) Bernard Malamud.
C) John Phillips Marquand.
D) François Mauriac.
E) Cormac McCarthy.

15. The period in British history between the execution of Charles I and the restoration of the monarchy under Charles II and during which John Milton, Thomas Hobbes, and Andrew Marvell wrote is the

A) Caroline Age, 1625-1649.
B) Commonwealth Interregnum, 1649-1660.
C) Edwardian Age, 1901-1914.
D) Neoclassic Period, 1660-1798.
E) Romantic Period, 1798-1870.

16. The Pulitzer Prize for Drama went to Stephen Sondheim (music and lyrics) and James Lapine (the book) in 1985 for their musical

A) *A Chorus Line.*
B) *Of Thee I Sing.*
C) *The Piano School.*
D) *Rent.*
E) *Sunday in the Park with George*.

17. A comic book or graphic novel, originally Japanese, that, since the early 1950s, presents in book form a story of fantasy, science fiction, or romance represents the style known as

A) anime.
B) bunraku.
C) kabuki.
D) manga.
E) senryu.

18. A pause or break in a line of verse, which in classical poetry usually occurs near the middle of a line, is the

A) cadence.
B) caesura.
C) chiasmus.
D) elision.
E) enjambment.

19. The figure of speech in which someone (usually, but not always absent), some abstract quality, or a nonexistent personage, is directly addressed as though present is

A) anaphora.
B) anthropomorphism.
C) apostrophe.
D) personification.
E) prosopopoeia.

20. Something that is itself and which also stands for something else and that, in a literary sense, combines a literal and sensuous quality with an abstract or suggestive aspect is a(n)

A) emblem.
B) icon.
C) kitsch.
D) logo.
E) symbol.

21. The group of eighteenth-century poets who wrote poems on death and immortality that attempted to establish an atmosphere of pleasing gloom in order to call up the horrors of death through the imagery of the charnel house is the

A) Graveyard School.
B) Kailyard School.
C) Lake School.
D) Satanic School.
E) Spasmodic School.

22. The group of American writers of the 1950s and the 1960s in rebellion against what they conceived of as the failures of American culture is the

A) Agrarians.
B) Angry Young Men.
C) Beat Generation.
D) Lollards.
E) Muckrakers.

23. **Not** among the poets who contributed to the nineteenth century's Romantic Movement in England is

A) Samuel Taylor Coleridge.
B) Percy Bysshe Shelley.
C) Robert Southey.
D) William Wordsworth.
E) William Butler Yeats.

24. A work or manner that blends censorious attitude with humor and wit for improving human institutions or humanity is

A) didacticism.
B) jeremiad.
C) repartee.
D) satire.
E) travesty.

25. The nineteenth-century English reform movement led by John Henry Newman, and attracting the attention of various literary men and women, is

A) the Free Verse Movement.
B) The Movement.
C) the Pre-Raphaelite Movement.
D) the Oxford Movement.
E) the Spoken Word Movement.

26. A poetic treatment of shepherds and rustic life, the more sophisticated concept involving inversion, through which the complex is put into the simple, i.e. an expressing of complex ideas through simple personages, is known as a

A) folk ballad.
B) lipogram.
C) pastoral.
D) requiem.
E) sapphic.

27. Poet of New England rural life and recipient of the Pulitzer Prize for Poetry in 1931, 1937, and 1943 is

A) Conrad Aiken.
B) W. H. Auden.
C) Robert Frost.
D) Anthony Hecht.
E) Robert Penn Warren.

28. The American author of *Beloved* and recipient of the 1993 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) Pearl S. Buck.
B) Nadine Gordimer.
C) Doris Lessing.
D) Toni Morrison.
E) Nelly Sachs.

29. The literary trope that can be used to heighten effect, including humorous effect, through exaggeration is

A) animism.
B) gigantism.
C) hyperbole.
D) litotes.
E) understatement.

30. A composition written as though intended to be sung out of doors at night under a window and in praise of a loved one is a(n)

A) aubade.
B) ballad.
C) charm.
D) lament.
E) serenade.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with Molière's *Tartuffe, or The Impostor.*
Items 37-43 are associated with Cormac McCarthy's *All the Pretty Horses.*
Items 44-50 are associated with Robert Browning's poetry (selected).

31. In *Tartuffe* Dorine's advice, "We shall use everything we can invoke. / Your father's mad; this thing is a bad joke; / But you had best indulge his antic bent / By the appearance of a meek consent [. . .]," refers to
    A) Orgon's intent to have Dorine marry Tartuffe.
    B) Orgon's intent to have Mariane marry Tartuffe.
    C) Orgon's intent to have Mariane marry Valère.
    D) Orgon's intent to have Tartuffe marry Damis.
    E) Orgon's intent to have Tartuffe marry Laurent.

32. Tartuffe's declaration, "[B]ut, since you inquire, / That's not the rapture to which I aspire; / And, Madame, it is elsewhere that I turn / For the felicity for which I yearn," constitutes a(n)
    A) confession of innocence.
    B) heaping figure.
    C) indecent proposal.
    D) invitation to a church service.
    E) *répondez s'il vous plait.*

33. Cléante's seeming disbelief, obvious in his question "Do you [. . .] / Equate artifice with sincerity, / And take similitude for verity?" is directed toward
    A) Dorine.
    B) Elmire.
    C) Mariane.
    D) Orgon.
    E) Tartuffe.

34. The lines "Just as love binds my sister and Valère, / As you know, for *his* sister I've my share" exhibit
    A) feminine rhyme.
    B) leonine rhyme.
    C) mosaic rhyme.
    D) slant rhyme.
    E) true rhyme.

35. Orgon's greatest worry is that Tartuffe has Orgon's
    A) daughter.
    B) house.
    C) soul.
    D) strongbox.
    E) wife.

36. "You've been too long deceived, / And I am tired of not being believed. / For our contentment, without more ado, / You shall observe all we've been telling you" is
    A) Damis's chiding of Laurent.
    B) Dorine's admonition to Mariane.
    C) Elmire's promise to Orgon.
    D) Filpote's promise to Laurent.
    E) Madame Pernelle's warning to Dorine.

---

37. In McCarthy's *All the Pretty Horses*, **not** crossing the Rio Grande "just out of Langtry, Texas" and heading south into Mexico early in the story is
    A) John Grady.
    B) Junior.
    C) Perez.
    D) Rawlins.
    E) Redbo.

38. Rawlins's "billfold jerked sideways off across the landscape and opened out and fell twisting to the ground like a broken bird" after
    A) Blevins shot it.
    B) Hector demanded identification.
    C) Perez tried to steal it.
    D) Rawlins dropped it.
    E) Rebo threw Rawlins.

39. "Scared money cant win and a worried man cant love" is advice John Grady receives from his/the
    A) father.
    B) grandfather.
    C) judge.
    D) lawyer.
    E) mother.

40. **Not** sixteen is the
    A) age at which Alfonsa became a freethinker.
    B) age Blevins's claims to be.
    C) age John Cole actually is.
    D) number of horses in the first group they break.
    E) number of nights that Alejandra came to Cole's bed.

41. That which—John Grady would have occasion to often reflect—has the "power to protect and to confer honor and to strengthen resolve and [. . .] to heal men and to bring them to safety after all other resources [have been] exhausted" are

A) friendships.
B) games of chess.
C) handshakes.
D) horses.
E) smiles.

42. Something of Blevins's character is revealed when, having fallen backwards off a bench in Reforma, Blevins whispers,

A) I cant trust anyone in this country.
B) I dont like to be laughed at.
C) Im gonna kill the sonovagun who made this bench.
D) This is worse than gettin struck by lightnin.
E) Youre gonna pay for this, Rawlins.

43. The avowal "I don't believe anybody could make up that story you just now got through telling us" is central to

A) Blevins's being allowed to ride John and Lacey.
B) John Grady's being hired by Don Hector.
C) John Grady's getting out of prison.
D) John Grady's inheriting the ranch.
E) John Grady's keeping the horse.

Items 44-50 refer to Robert Browning's

My Last Duchess

That's my last Duchess painted on the wall,
Looking as if she were alive. I call
That piece a wonder, now: Frà Pandolf's hands
Worked busily a day, and there she stands.
Will't please you sit and look at her? I said
'Frà Pandolf' by design, for never read
Strangers like you that pictured countenance,
The depth and passion of its earnest glance,
But to myself they turned (since none puts by
The curtain I have drawn for you, but I)
And seemed as they would ask me, if they durst,
How such a glance came there; so, not the first
Are you to turn and ask thus. Sir, 'twas not
Her husband's presence only, called that spot
Of joy into the Duchess' cheek: perhaps
Frà Pandolf chanced to say "Her mantle laps
Over my Lady's wrist too much," or "Paint
Must never hope to reproduce the faint
Half-flush that dies along her throat": such stuff
Was courtesy, she thought, and cause enough
For calling up that spot of joy. She had
A heart — how shall I say?—too soon made glad,
Too easily impressed; she liked whate'er
She looked on, and her looks went everywhere.
Sir, 'twas all one! My favour at her breast,
The dropping of the daylight in the West,
The bough of cherries some officious fool
Broke in the orchard for her, the white mule
She rode with round the terrace — all and each
Would draw from her alike the approving speech,
Or blush, at least. She thanked men,—good! But thanked
Somehow—I know not how—as if she ranked
My gift of a nine-hundred-years-old name
With anybody's gift. Who'd stoop to blame
This sort of trifling? Even had you skill
In speech—(which I have not)—to make your will
Quite clear to such an one, and say, 'Just this
Or that in you disgusts me; here you miss,
Or there exceed the mark'—and if she let
Herself be lessoned so, nor plainly set
Her wits to yours, forsooth, and made excuse,
—E'en then would be some stooping, and I choose
Never to stoop. Oh sir, she smiled, no doubt,
Whene'er I passed her; but who passed without
Much the same smile? This grew; I gave commands:
Then all smiles stopped together. There she stands
As if alive. Will't please you rise? We'll meet
The company below, then. I repeat,
The Count your master's known munificence
Is ample warrant that no just pretence
Of mine for dowry will be disallowed;
Though his fair daughter's self, as I avowed
At starting, is my object. Nay, we'll go
Together down, sir. Notice Neptune, though,
Taming a sea-horse, thought a rarity,
Which Claus of Innsbruck cast in bronze for me!

44. The opening lines of Browning's "My Last Duchess" offer an example of one of the dramatic monologue's major characteristics, which is

A) blank verse.
B) dramatic action.
C) implied action.
D) silent auditor.
E) unwitting revelation.

45. Frà Pandolf is a

A) painter.
B) philanderer.
C) photographer.
D) Phransican.
E) player.

46. The fate of the persona's last duchess is at best

A) adverted.
B) ambiguous.
C) deserved.
D) detailed in full.
E) easily understood.

47. The "spot of joy" (lines 14-15; 21) is the Duchess's

A) beauty mark.
B) blush.
C) dimple.
D) freckle.
E) sparkle in her eyes.

48. The deeply engrained emotion that the Duke of Ferrera unwittingly reveals is a(n)

A) arrogant jealousy.
B) frustrated amusement.
C) loving empathy.
D) shameful powerlessness.
E) troubled aversion.

49. The persona of the poem seems to value, as it were, the portrait of his duchess over the actual woman because the

A) portrait has a resale value.
B) portrait exaggerates the duchess's beauty.
C) portrait is totally within his control.
D) portrait's beauty cannot fade.
E) silent auditor is mesmerized by the portrait.

50. Scansion of Robert Browning's "My Last Duchess" reveals an overall metric pattern of

A) iambic pentameter.
B) iambic tetrameter.
C) iambic trimeter.
D) trochaic pentameter.
E) trochaic trimeter.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-55 refer to Frederick Turner's

110 Degrees in Dallas

A few vague clouds in the insane blue sky,
The rabbits on the grass are stunned and tame.
A milk-green mantle chokes the shrunken dream.
A hackberry, heat-shocked, begins to die.
The summer suburbs give off one long hum
Of worn compressors fading with a sigh.
A parched cicada shrieks and then falls dumb.
The grackles march, beak gaped, with deranged eye.
The summer's now so old it's lost its mind.
It's quite forgotten what's the way to rain.
The sun sees everything, except it's blind.
The sky, as we begin, is still insane.
This is the test of all that life can stand.
And being, being presses on the land.

51. The form of Frederick Turner's "110 Degrees in Dallas" approximates the

A) Anglo-Italian sonnet.
B) Miltonic sonnet.
C) Petrarchan sonnet.
D) Shakespearean sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

52. The fullness of effect of line 11, "The sun sees everything, except it's blind," in Turner's sonnet depends on

A) hyperbole.
B) metaphor.
C) oxymoron.
D) paradox.
E) simile.

53. The melopoetic feature characterizing lines 2, 3, 5, 6, 7, 9, 11, 12, and 13, especially, is

A) assonance.
B) consonance.
C) resonance.
D) sigmatism.
E) syncopation.

54. Line 7's imagery, both in its presence and in its negation, is

A) auditory.
B) gustatory.
C) olfactory.
D) tactile.
E) visual.

55. Summer's senility (line 9) is an example of

A) allegory.
B) apostrophe.
C) hyperbole.
D) mimesis.
E) personification.

Items 56-60 refer to Vaida Stewart Montgomery's

Funeral

Out on the prairie the small owls call.
The cattle are holding a funeral.

They mill around a stack of bones,
And grieve their dead in plaintive moans.

Each must sniff at the carcass there—
A hunk of hide and horn and hair.

He was their brother, before he fell,
A victim of drouth, or of stampede's hell.

Now he is dead, and they bleat and bawl,
While over the prairie the small owls call.

56. The melopoetic feature characterizing lines 4 and 9 is

A) cacophony.
B) dissonance.
C) euphony.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) zeugma.

57. The type of rhyme **not** found in V. S. Montgomery's "Funeral" is

A) feminine.
B) heteromerous.
C) internal.
D) masculine.
E) true.

58. Overall, the predominating type of imagery giving life to Montgomery's poem is

A) auditory.
B) gustatory.
C) olfactory.
D) tactile.
E) visual.

59. Line 6 of "Funeral" is characterized by

A) allegory.
B) alliteration.
C) assonance.
D) consonance.
E) dissonance.

60. The decasyllabic lines that constitute the poem should be recognized in terms of the

A) ballad.
B) cinquain.
C) couplet.
D) quatrain.
E) triolet.

Items 61-65 refer to Billy Collins's

Sonnet

All we need is fourteen lines, well, thirteen now,
and after this one just a dozen
to launch a little ship on love's storm-tossed seas,
then only ten more left like rows of beans.
How easily it goes unless you get Elizabethan
and insist the iambic bongos must be played
and rhymes positioned at the ends of lines,
one for every station of the cross.
But hang on here wile we make the turn
into the final six where all will be resolved,
where longing and heartache will find an end,
where Laura will tell Petrarch to put down his pen,
take off those crazy medieval tights,
blow out the lights, and come at last to bed.

61. The reference to Petrarch that Collins's expects his audience to recognize in his "Sonnet" is a(n)

A) allonym.
B) allusion.
C) dead metaphor.
D) denotation.
E) double entendre.

62. The "iambic bongos" of line 6, in which something closely associated with rhythm but not actually a part of the poem's metrics, is an occurrence of

A) irony.
B) litotes.
C) metonymy.
D) paradox.
E) simile.

63. The striking and elaborate comparison of line 3, in which the sonnet itself is likened to a ship upon "love's storm-tossed seas" constitutes, despite the poem's tone, a

A) climax.
B) conceit.
C) hyperbole.
D) metaphor.
E) pun.

64. The poem's lack of both a rhyme scheme and a consistent rhythm suggests that Collins's sonnet, through indirect criticism of the form itself, is a

A) fixed form.
B) nonsense verse.
C) paean.
D) parody.
E) vignette.

65. Line 9, "But hang on here wile," in which the turn in thought takes place, is the location of the poem's

A) antithesis.
B) harangue.
C) reversal.
D) sequel.
E) volta.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Robert Browning's "Love in Life," and discuss the poet's treatment of the pursuit of love.

Love in Life

Room after room,
I hunt the house through
We inhabit together.
Heart, fear nothing, for, heart, thou shalt find her—
Next time, herself!—not the trouble behind her
Left in the curtain, the couch's perfume!
As she brushed it, the cornice*-wreath blossomed anew:
Yon looking-glass gleaned* at the wave of her feather.

Yet the day wears,
And door succeeds door;
I try the fresh fortune—
Range the wide house from the wing to the centre.
Still the same chance! She goes out as I enter.
Spend my whole day in the quest,—who cares?
But 'tis twilight, you see,—with such suites* to explore,
Such closets to search, such alcoves* to importune!*

ornamental molding on a wall
obtained; extracted
a group of rooms
small sections of a room
to ask persistently

KEY

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line arrows up ➔

1.	B	49
2.	E	334
3.	C	561
4.	B	47
5.	A	129
6.	D	310
7.	A	602
8.	D	418
9.	A	600
10.	B	257
11.	A	13
12.	B	174
13.	E	498
14.	E	603
15.	B	102
16.	E	608
17.	D	285
18.	B	71
19.	C	37
20.	E	467
21.	A	221
22.	C	51
23.	E	79
24.	D	427
25.	D	344
26.	C	354
27.	C	604
28.	D	601
29.	C	242
30.	E	440
31.	B	283
32.	C	289
33.	D	261
34.	E	220
35.	D	312
36.	C	304
37.	C	186
38.	A	48
39.	A	247
40.	E	142
41.	E	219
42.	B	53
43.	E	288
44.	C	
45.	A	
46.	B	
47.	B	
48.	A	
49.	C	
50.	A	
51.	D	442
52.	D	349
53.	D	
54.	A	
55.	E	361
56.	D	337
57.	A	
58.	A	
59.	B	13
60.	C	112
61.	B	14
62.	C	298
63.	B	104
64.	D	353
65.	E	498

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

DO NOT
mark (cross out)
actual **LETTER** answer;
mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e,

to the Signet *Tartuffe*,

to the Vintage *Pretty*,

and to Penguin's Browning collection.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Robert Browning's "Love in Life"

Literary concepts that **MIGHT** be used in a discussion of the psychology of memory in Browning's "Love in Life" include

alliteration,
allusion,
anaphora (internal),
apostrophe,
conceit,
controlling image,
feminine rhyme,
imagery,
liminality,
line length,
metaphor,
meter,
metonymy,
paradox,
rhopalic,
theme,
threshold, and
tone.

The contestant might remain with the literal pursuit, the "hunt" of line 2, or she might recognize the hunt as a controlling image (extended metaphor) that pervades the poem's two stanzas. In either case, the optimism appears to be driven by the speaker's memory of what love is or what love should be, especially as it is understood in terms of a single lover (girlfriend) or, perhaps, looking for another lover. The house might be seen in the literal sense or in the figurative, the hunt through the house with its many rooms and doors as a journey through life with its many relationships (or stages of relationships) and its many thresholds—the poem's theme of liminality. The imagery that reinforces the controlling image, the hunt as a journey, and that makes the connection between the first and second stanzas is found in the metaphorical "the day wears" and "door succeeds door." The speaker is getting older, and the journey's timeframe (line 15: "'tis twilight") is closing; the hunt is getting less localized as it moves into the fullness of the house.

The memories evoked and represented by both the perfume and the reflection in the mirror become the catalysts for his continued search. Memory, inferred through the several images of succession, especially the speaker's apparent experience with/knowledge of suites, closets, and alcoves seems to drive/entice the speaker to complete his quest, as if this quest is either a new one—based on memorable experience—or a continued quest.

The student might, after the contests of course, compare Browning's "Love in Life" with Adele's "Chasing Pavements," noting that "chasing pavements" is a British colloquialism for a "fruitless activity" including, perhaps, finding or hunting for love. Regarding Browning's own poetry: this poem might be an easy way into a study of "Childe Roland to the Dark Tower Came."